Rubric for First Demo (Initial Project Build)

October 23, 2026

Introduction

This rubric is designed to evaluate the first demo of the project, focusing on the initial implementation milestone. By this stage, approximately 30% of the overall functionality should be implemented and demonstrated. The demo should show tangible progress, including:

- Core functionality implemented and running
- Use of an automated version control system (e.g., Git)
- Use of an automated unit testing framework (e.g., JUnit, `pytest`, etc.)
- Team coordination and planning toward future iterations

Criteria Descriptions

1. **Functionality Implemented (40%)**
   Assesses whether roughly 30% of the project's planned features are functional and operational. Focuses on demonstrated, running features rather than placeholders or mockups.

2. **Use of Version Control (15%)**
   Assesses consistent and effective use of a version control system (e.g., Git). Includes regular commits, meaningful commit messages, and clear collaboration among team members.

3. **Use of Automated Testing Framework (15%)**
   Evaluates evidence of test setup and basic unit tests using an automated testing framework. Emphasis is on correctness of setup and integration into the development process, even if test coverage is partial at this stage.

4. **Presentation and Clarity of Demo (20%)**
   Assesses how clearly and effectively the team presents the demo — organization, flow, and explanation of implemented features, tools used, and next steps.

5. **Planning and Next Steps (10%)**
   Evaluates how well the team articulates their development plan for the next increment, identifies challenges, and demonstrates a clear understanding of the project roadmap.

Criteria	Excellent (90–100%)	Good (80–89%)	Satisfactory (70–79%)	Needs Improvement (60–69%)	Poor (Below 60%)
Functionality Implemented (40%)	∼30% of planned features are fully implemented, functional, and integrated; demo runs smoothly and shows a solid foundation for further development.	Most key features are functional with minor issues or incomplete integration.	Some features work, but functionality is limited or partially implemented.	Minimal functionality demonstrated; significant issues present.	Little or no functionality; non-operational or mostly conceptual.
Use of Version Control (15%)	Regular commits with meaningful messages; clear collaboration and use of branches or pull requests.	Consistent commit history with mostly meaningful messages; some evidence of collaboration.	Some commits made but inconsistent; limited collaborative use.	Minimal commits or unclear version history.	No visible use of version control or single bulk commit.
Use of Automated Testing Framework (15%)	Automated testing framework properly set up; multiple tests implemented and passing; testing integrated into workflow.	Framework configured with a few tests running successfully; minor setup issues.	Framework identified but only minimal or partial testing done.	Framework setup incomplete; mostly manual testing.	No automated testing framework used or no evidence of tests.
Presentation and Clarity of Demo (20%)	Clear, well-structured presentation; excellent explanation of features, design decisions, and next steps; confident delivery.	Mostly clear and organized presentation; minor gaps in explanation or structure.	Adequate explanation of implemented features; some disorganization or unclear parts.	Unclear presentation; missing or poorly explained components.	Disorganized, confusing, or incomplete presentation; difficult to follow.
Planning and Next Steps (10%)	Team clearly articulates development roadmap; identifies challenges and realistic next goals; strong teamwork evident.	Team presents a reasonable plan with minor gaps or vague areas.	Some next steps discussed but lacking detail or coordination.	Next steps unclear; limited evidence of planning or collaboration.	No clear plan for future work; team appears unprepared.

Criteria	Total Points	Grading Levels
Functionality Implemented	40	Excellent (36–40) Good (32–35) Satisfactory (28–31) Needs Improvement (24–27) Poor (<24)
Use of Version Control	15	Excellent (14–15) Good (12–13) Satisfactory (11) Needs Improvement (9–10) Poor (<9)
Use of Automated Testing Framework	15	Excellent (14–15) Good (12–13) Satisfactory (11) Needs Improvement (9–10) Poor (<9)
Presentation and Clarity of Demo	20	Excellent (18–20) Good (16–17) Satisfactory (14–15) Needs Improvement (12–13) Poor (<12)
Planning and Next Steps	10	Excellent (9–10) Good (8) Satisfactory (7) Needs Improvement (6) Poor (<6)